

A Soviet R-7 (NATO designation SS-6 Sapwood) InterContinental Ballistic Missile (ICBM)). Moscow lagged well behand the United States in the quality and quantity of its ICBMs. Until the autumn of 1961, though, the Americans believed the Soviets were winning the arms race (the so-called ‘missile gap’). During the missile crisis, the Soviets had some forty ICBMs, The Americans had 182. This was in addition to their long-range bombers and submarine-based missiles, where the United States also enjoyed very significant superiority. *(Public Domain)*